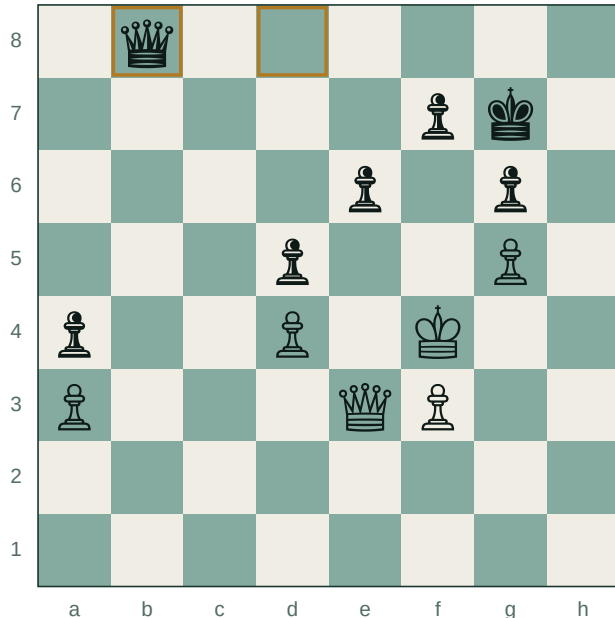


Queen-ending tactics: White, move 45

Queen-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 44...Qb8+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

45. Qe5+ Qxe5+ 46. Kxe5 Kf8 47. Kd6

45.Qe5+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. From e5 it attacks king on g7 and queen on b8. Recorded reply: **45...Qxe5+**.

46.Kxe5 The king captures the queen on e5. Recorded reply: **46...Kf8**.

47.Kd6 The king moves from e5 to d6.

At the end, nominal material is White 4 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on g7. Geometrically undefended: queen on b8. Check for tactical protection.